PARIS, MARCH 12, 1932

The Match King is found dead.

> Then the auditors opened the books.

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Ivar Kreuger builds Swedish Match, 1917.

⅔ to ¾

Share of world match production he controlled

Monopolies in 15 countries, bought with loans.

He lends governments money.

FRANCE, 1927

$75 million

GERMANY, 1929

$125 million

Dividends of 20% or more, 1917 to 1924.

Big payouts need ever more new cash.

💸 High dividends

📈 New investors

🔁 Repeat

£28.7 million of forged Italian bonds.

~~“Italian government bonds”~~

The largest bankruptcy to that date.

$250M-$400M

Estimated investor losses (estimates vary)

YOUR RULE

A payout funded by new money is a warning.

1. Check payouts against cash generated
2. Ask what happens if new money stops
3. Distrust returns that look too smooth

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